A. Fill in the blanks using the words given in the box to complete the summary of the poem:

King Richard the Second, had surrendered to his (a)_____ cousin, Bollingbroke. He experienced deep distress at the horror of his circumstances. In that desperate situation, he speaks of (b)_____, (c)_____, (d)_____ and other things connected with death. He spoke of how people leave nothing behind and can call nothing their own, except for the small patch of (e)_____, where they will be buried. King Richard yielded to dejection and talked of all the different ways in which defeated kings suffer how some had been deposed, (f)_____ in war, (g)_____ by their wives and so forth. He attributed this loss of lives to (h)_____, who he personified as the jester who watches over the shoulder of every ruler, who mocks kings by allowing them to think their human flesh, was like (i)_____brass. However, Death penetrates through the castle walls, silently and unnoticed like a sharp (j)_____, thus bidding (k)_____ to him and all his pride forever. Finally, Richard appealed to his soldiers not to mock his mere flesh and blood by showing (l) _____ and respect to him. He added that he too needed bread to live, felt want, tasted (m)_____ and needed (n)_____. He concluded thus, urging his men not to call him a (o)_____ as he was only human, just like the rest of them.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **barren-earth** | **friends** | **graves** | **slain** |
| **rebellious** | **poisoned** | **worms** | **grief** |
| **impregnable** | **epitaphs** | **death** | **farewell** |
| **reverence** | **king** | **pin** | |

B. The words used by Shakespeare find a place in present day conversations also. Here are a few examples of how these poetic, standardized English words could be used by common people in their regular speech.

**a. Fill in the blanks with appropriate words from the box and complete the statements suitably:**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **bequeath** | **antics** | **monarchise** |
| **impregnable** | **hollow** | |

1. Shravan never keeps his promises. His friends know that his words are _____.
2. The spectators died laughing at the _____ of the clown.
3. The business woman wished to _____ all her riches to an orphanage, after her death.
4. The fortress was _____ and could not be conquered by the enemies.
5. Alexander the Great, wished to conquer many lands and _____ the entire world.

DO YOU KNOW?

Shakespeare wrote about 37 plays, which are broadly categorized under three heads, namely tragedies, comedies and histories.

The historic play '*Richard II*' is the only play written entirely in verse.



06-B-Poem-The Hollow Crown.indd 186 11-01-2019 15:41:09